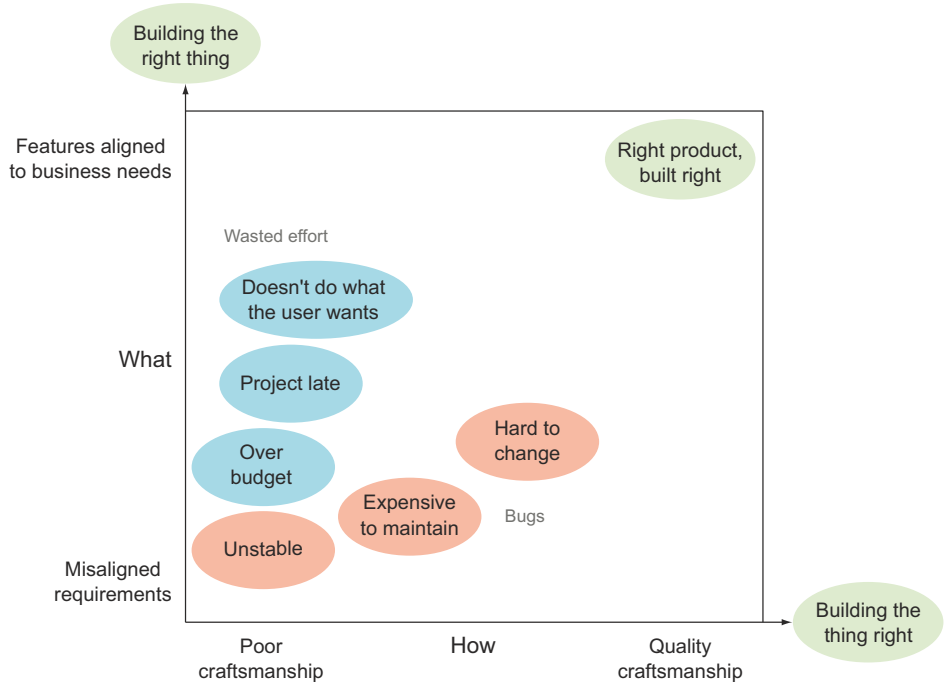


Figure 1.3 Successful projects must both build features well and build the right features.

delivering new features quickly because each release requires a lengthy period of manual testing and bug fixes.

Organizations that embrace high-quality technical practices have a different story to tell. I've seen many teams that adopt practices such as Test-Driven Development, Clean Coding, Living Documentation, and Continuous Integration regularly reporting low to near-zero defect rates, as well as code that's much easier to adapt and extend as new requirements emerge and new features are requested. These teams can also add features at a more consistent pace, because the automated tests ensure that existing features won't be broken unknowingly. They implement the features faster and more precisely than other teams because they don't have to struggle with long bug-fixing sessions and unpredictable side effects when they make changes. And the resulting application is easier and cheaper to maintain.

Note that there is no magic formula for building high-quality, easily maintainable software. Software development is a complex field, human factors abound, and techniques such as Test-Driven Development, Clean Coding, and Automated Testing don't automatically guarantee good results. But studies do suggest a strong correlation between lean and Agile practices and project success rates[4] when compared to more

[4] See, for example, Ambysoft, "2013 IT Project Success Rates Survey Results," http://www.ambysoft.com/surveys/success2013.html.